Prepared for [IDA IRELAND / DEPT. OF ENTERPRISE — FILL]
Joe Stein, CEO · Justin Fowler, COO · April 2026
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A European Manufacturing Base for the GLP-1 Companion Nutrition Category

Matchbox 7 holds the exclusive Americas licence for **Monch** — a proprietary water-soluble fibre with 3.3× the gut bioavailability of standard fibre, clinically aligned to the metabolic needs of the 15M+ Americans (and rapidly growing global cohort) on GLP-1 medications. We are evaluating Ireland as the strategic European production and ingredient-licensing hub. This brief sets out the market scale, the science, the "why Ireland" rationale, and a partnership ask sized to a multi-decade category.

$58B→$133B
Global GLP-1 drug market, 2026 → 2035 (Evaluate Pharma / IQVIA)

$15.8B
US protein bar + electrolyte TAM today, 7–10% CAGR

15M+
Active US GLP-1 users; 74% suffer GI side effects no product solves

3.3×
Monch fibre gut bioavailability vs. standard fibre (~40% vs ~12%)

WHY NOW — THREE IRREVERSIBLE CATALYSTS

MARCH 2026
Semaglutide Patent Cliff
Primary patent expired globally. India, Canada, Brazil, China (40% of world population) gain generic access; EU follows. Global GLP-1 user base projected to grow 2–3×.

2026 — ONGOING
Oral GLP-1 Pills Launch
Oral formulations remove the injection barrier. Clinical data shows ~80% GI side-effect rates — even higher than injectables — expanding the addressable patient pool.

Q1 2026
Gut Health = Capital Magnet
Gut-health products captured 30% of food venture capital in Q1 2026. Microbiome-mediated GLP-1 modulation is the most-funded sub-thesis in functional nutrition.

THE DUAL REVENUE ENGINE — WHY A EUROPEAN FACTORY, NOT JUST A BRAND

Engine 1 · Branded Consumer Products
Monch Protein + Fibre Bar (Y1 flagship), Electrolyte Packet (Y1 attach), Functional Drink (H1 Y2). Built with the team behind Muscle Milk. Base-case Y2 revenue: **$3.6M** at 57% gross margin. Strong — but on its own this consumes only ~43% of current production capacity.

Engine 2 · B2B Ingredient Licensing — The Scale Play
Water-soluble Monch can be incorporated into *any* consumer food product. At a target cost of **$0.10/serving** (vs. $0.37 today), Monch becomes credible to license to Cargill, Tate & Lyle, ADM, IFF, DSM-Firmenich. Typical deal: **500 MT/yr min, 5–7 yr exclusivity**. **This channel requires — and justifies — plant-scale European manufacturing.**

WHY IRELAND — FOUR STRATEGIC PILLARS

SCIENCE CLUSTER ALIGNMENT
APC Microbiome Ireland (UCC, Cork)
Monch's mechanism — water-soluble fibre → SCFA fermentation → microbiome modulation → endogenous GLP-1 production — sits squarely in APC's research domain. APC is one of the world's three most-cited microbiome centres. A formal R&D partnership accelerates clinical validation and underpins KDB-qualifying IP development on Irish soil.

PHARMA ECOSYSTEM ADJACENCY
Companion to a Cluster That Already Exists
Lilly (manufacturer of tirzepatide / Mounjaro / Zepbound), Pfizer, AbbVie, MSD, and Novo Nordisk-adjacent partners all manufacture in Ireland. A GLP-1 *companion* nutrition platform is the natural civilian-side bookend to that pharmaceutical infrastructure — supply chain, regulatory, and talent transfer.

MARKET ACCESS
EU Production Base, Post-Patent-Cliff
The semaglutide patent cliff opens EU markets to generic GLP-1 drugs and a massive new patient cohort needing companion products. An Irish facility serves the EU, UK, and EMEA from inside the single market — and dual-sources us against current China-sole supply concentration.

FISCAL & CAPITAL FIT
KDB + R&D Credit + IDA Capital Grants
The **Knowledge Development Box (6.25%)** on qualifying IP-derived income is purpose-built for the Engine-2 ingredient-licensing royalty stream. Combined with the **25% R&D Tax Credit**, **12.5% corporation tax**, and IDA grants, Ireland is the most fiscally efficient EU jurisdiction for an IP-heavy ingredient business.

DEFENSIBILITY — FIVE LAYERS OF MOAT

IP
Exclusive Monch Licence
Americas (ex-Chile); EMEA expansion contemplated as part of this engagement. Sole-supply contractual guarantee from BioLumen.

PEDIGREE
Muscle Milk Team
Greg Pickett (Muscle Milk founder, $450M Hormel exit) develops our flavour profiles via Flavor Insights — 111K sq ft facility, Benicia CA.

FORMULATION
Only Bar in Class
Premium chocolate + 15g protein + proprietary fibre + integrated electrolytes + clean sweetening. No competitor combines all five.

TIMING
First-Mover
While Nestlé and major CPG *discuss* companion products at conferences, we are shipping. 18–24 month head start on category creation.

THE PARTNERSHIP ASK

Project Monch — A European Centre for the GLP-1 Companion Category

A purpose-built Irish facility producing **500–1,500 MT/yr of water-soluble Monch fibre** with co-located bar, packet, and powder finishing capability. Sized to anchor Engine-2 ingredient-licensing supply contracts and serve EU/EMEA branded demand from a single base.

WHAT IRELAND GAINS

- → **Capital deployment:** [€XX–XX M total project FILL] facility CapEx + working capital.
- → **Direct employment:** [60–120 FTE FILL] in food science, process engineering, QC, supply chain, commercial — plus indirect jobs in packaging, logistics, R&D.
- → **Export intensity:** Functional ingredient + branded SKUs exported to US, EU, UK, MENA. KDB-qualifying ingredient royalties booked in Ireland.
- → **Cluster reinforcement:** Establishes Ireland as the European centre for the GLP-1 companion nutrition category — a brand-new sub-sector with no existing geographic anchor.
- → **R&D anchoring:** Multi-year funded research programme with APC Microbiome Ireland and Teagasc Moorepark; clinical work with Irish-led publications.

WHAT WE ARE ASKING FOR

- → **IDA Ireland capital grant package** sized to the agreed CapEx and FTE commitments under the standard IDA framework.
- → **Site selection & expedited planning** support — preferred locations under evaluation in [Cork / Limerick / Galway — FILL].
- → **R&D collaboration** letter of intent with APC Microbiome Ireland (UCC) and Teagasc; Disruptive Technologies Innovation Fund eligibility review.
- → **Knowledge Development Box** qualifying-asset structuring guidance for the Monch ingredient IP held in the Irish entity.
- → **Workforce development partnership** via Skillnet Ireland / Springboard for food-science and process-engineering roles.

TEAM & STRATEGIC PARTNERS

Joe Stein
CEO · STRATEGIC LEADERSHIP
Recapitalisation lead; investor and government relations.

Justin Fowler
COO · OPERATIONS & STRATEGY
Supply chain, manufacturing partnerships, GTM architecture, financial model.

Greg Pickett
STRATEGIC ADVISOR
Muscle Milk founder; CytoSport $0→$200M; $450M Hormel exit (2014). Now Flavor Insights.

Flavor Insights
FORMULATION PARTNER
Nikki Brown & Michael Pickett — taste team behind the Muscle Milk breakthrough.

Bill Hilts (Mr. Bill's)
US CO-PACK & FORMULATION
Development agreement signed April 2026. US dual-source for branded SKUs.

BioLumen
EXCLUSIVE INGREDIENT SUPPLIER
Sole producer of Monch fibre; exclusive Americas licence to Matchbox 7; EMEA territory under negotiation.